PROJECT DOCUMENT

Auto Ticket Classification Using Flow Designer

ServiceNow System Administration Project

Project Area	IT Service Desk Automation
Platform	ServiceNow – Flow Designer
Document Type	Project Report / Implementation Plan
Primary Goal	Automatically classify incoming support tickets

Prepared from the project details visible in the supplied screenshot. Add your name, class, and institution before submission if required.

ServiceNow System Administration Project

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1. Introduction

A school IT helpdesk receives support requests every day from students and staff. Common issues include network connectivity problems, hardware failures, account access difficulties, and system performance issues. When every ticket is reviewed and categorized manually, the process takes time and may lead to inconsistent classification.

This project proposes an automated ticket-classification workflow using ServiceNow Flow Designer. The workflow checks the information in a newly created ticket, identifies the issue type using defined conditions, assigns an appropriate category and subcategory, and notifies the requester or relevant support team.

2. Problem Statement

The current manual process requires IT staff to inspect each ticket, determine its issue type, select the correct category and subcategory, and communicate ticket creation. As the number of requests increases, this process becomes time-consuming, error-prone, and difficult to scale.

3. Objectives

- Automate the classification of incoming IT support tickets.
- Apply consistent categories and subcategories based on ticket details.
- Reduce repetitive manual work for helpdesk staff.
- Notify the appropriate people when a ticket is created or processed.
- Improve response consistency and make the workflow easier to maintain.

4. Scope of the Project

- Trigger the workflow when a new incident or support ticket is created.
- Read selected ticket fields such as short description, description, and existing category.
- Use conditions to identify common issue types.
- Update category, subcategory, and assignment details where appropriate.
- Send an email notification confirming ticket creation or routing.
- Test the flow with representative examples and review execution results.

5. Proposed Classification Rules

The exact category values should match the choices configured in the ServiceNow instance. The following table is an example rule set and can be adapted to the project environment.

Example issue keywords	Suggested category	Suggested subcategory
Wi-Fi, network, internet, connection	Network	Connectivity
Laptop, keyboard, monitor, hardware	Hardware	Device / Peripheral
Login, password, account locked	Software or Account	Access / Login
Slow, freezing, performance	Software or System	Performance
No matching rule	General / Other	Unclassified

Note: These are sample rules, not a claim that the rules are already configured. Avoid relying only on keywords in a production system; review edge cases and ensure a safe fallback category is available.

6. Tools and Components

- ServiceNow platform: stores incidents and related records.
- Flow Designer: defines the trigger, conditions, actions, and flow sequence.
- Incident or ticket table: provides the record that the flow evaluates and updates.
- If/Else conditions: map ticket details to the intended classification.
- Update Record action: saves the category, subcategory, and routing information.
- Email Notification action: sends a message to the requester or support group.
- Update Sets: capture eligible configuration changes for movement between instances.

7. Implementation Plan

Milestone 1 – Requirement Analysis and Planning

- Identify the common support issues handled by the school IT helpdesk.
- Define the categories, subcategories, and routing rules.
- Create a simple use case and list the expected input and output for each rule.
- Confirm which ticket fields may be updated automatically.

Activity 1 – Business Use Case

Use case: a student submits a ticket saying that the campus Wi-Fi is not connecting. The flow detects network-related terms, assigns the Network / Connectivity classification, routes the ticket if a support group is configured, and sends a confirmation notification.

Activity 2 – Create a New Update Set

Create and select a named update set before making configuration changes, where appropriate. This helps package supported customizations for transfer to another ServiceNow instance. Verify that each required configuration item is captured; not every record or data change is automatically included in an update set.

Activity 3 – Navigation Steps

- Sign in to the ServiceNow instance with the required permissions.
- Open Flow Designer from the application navigator.
- Create a new flow and give it a clear, descriptive name.
- Choose a record-created trigger for the appropriate incident or ticket table.
- Add conditions for the issue types to be recognized.
- Add actions to update classification fields and send notifications.
- Save, test, and activate the flow after validating the behavior.

Milestone 2 – Backend Development and Configuration

Configure the trigger, conditions, and record-update actions. Confirm that the selected fields and choice values are valid in the target instance. Where assignment is required, map each issue type to a valid support group and confirm that the flow does not overwrite important values unnecessarily.

Milestone 3 – Automation Using Flow Designer and Email Notification

Add an email action to inform the requester that the ticket was received, or notify the relevant support team when routing occurs. Use suitable recipients and include useful ticket information such as the ticket number, short description, and current status. Do not include passwords or other sensitive information in the email.

Milestone 4 – Testing and Validation

Test the flow with different issue descriptions, including known keywords, mixed issues, blank descriptions, and unmatched requests. Confirm that the correct fields are updated, notifications are sent once, and flow execution details show no unexpected errors.

8. Sample Workflow

Step	Action
1	A user creates a new incident/ticket.
2	Flow Designer detects the new record.
3	Conditions inspect relevant ticket fields.
4	The matching category and subcategory are selected.
5	The ticket record is updated and optionally assigned.
6	A confirmation or routing email is sent.
7	The flow execution is reviewed for success or errors.

9. Testing Plan

Test case	Expected result
Network-related ticket	Network / Connectivity is selected.
Hardware-related ticket	Hardware category is selected.
Login or password issue	Account/access rule is applied.
Unknown or unclear issue	Fallback category is used or manual review is flagged.
Notification check	Correct recipient receives a useful confirmation.
Duplicate/updated record check	Flow does not create repeated or unwanted notifications.

10. Benefits

- Reduces manual effort in repetitive ticket classification.
- Encourages consistent categorization across helpdesk requests.
- Can improve routing speed when assignment rules are configured correctly.

- Provides a repeatable process that can be maintained and expanded.
- Email notifications improve communication with requesters and support teams.

11. Limitations and Considerations

- Keyword rules may misclassify vague, misspelled, or multi-issue descriptions.
- Category and subcategory values vary by ServiceNow configuration.
- Required roles and permissions are needed to build and activate flows.
- Notifications must be tested to avoid incorrect recipients or duplicate messages.
- Uncertain cases should be sent for manual review rather than forcing an incorrect classification.

12. Conclusion

Auto Ticket Classification using Flow Designer is a practical way to streamline a school IT helpdesk workflow. By defining clear requirements, configuring classification conditions, updating ticket records, and sending appropriate notifications, the project can reduce repetitive work and improve consistency. Thorough testing and a fallback path for unclear requests are important before the flow is used in a live environment.

13. Details to Complete Before Submission

- Student name and register number
- Department / course and institution name
- Faculty guide name, if required
- Screenshots of the configured flow and successful test executions
- Any category names, assignment groups, or rules specific to your instance